

PowerBI User Group:

News and Updates

27 August 2026

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News & Monthly Update

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Speaker Introduction



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Announcements

Copilot

- Copilot Summary and Copilot narrative can now read visuals behind hidden bookmarks
 - Copilot previously skipped visuals that were hidden by a bookmark.
 - Visuals are read in place with no changes to the Bookmark state: RLS & OLS still fully enforced

Generally Available (GA)

- Modern visual defaults and customize themes formatting panes
 - New reports created in PowerBI Desktop and PowerBI Service starts off with the *Fluent 2* base theme
 - Go to the Theme Pane to set your base theme, adjust colours (for your brand) or pick one of the available colour palettes.
 - Change a font in one place in order to update titles callouts, labels and general text across every visual in your report.



Announcements

Generally Available (GA) – continued



- Matrix
 - Expand and collapse for column headers now available
 - Column headers in the matrix visual can now be collapsed like the row headers
 - Set the default freeze state for row headers in the format pane (useful for mobile reports)
 - This default is saved with the report and applies to all users who view this

- Date picker for slicer
 - Clear selections is now available from the header icon.
 - Single date is available and restricts the slicer to one date at a time.



- Centre value for donut chart
 - A value can now be shown in the centre without any additional overlay card
 - Add an additional label above/ below the value, place an image above/ below or add a custom measure

Subcategory		Gadgets		Widgets		Total
Year		Product C	Product D	Total		
Year 1		335	438	773	963	1736
	Q1	80	110	190	215	405
	Q2	92	105	197	223	420
	Q3	75	98	173	250	423
	Q4	88	125	213	275	488
Year 2		195	270	465	525	990
Total		530	708	1238	1488	2726



Announcements – Maps

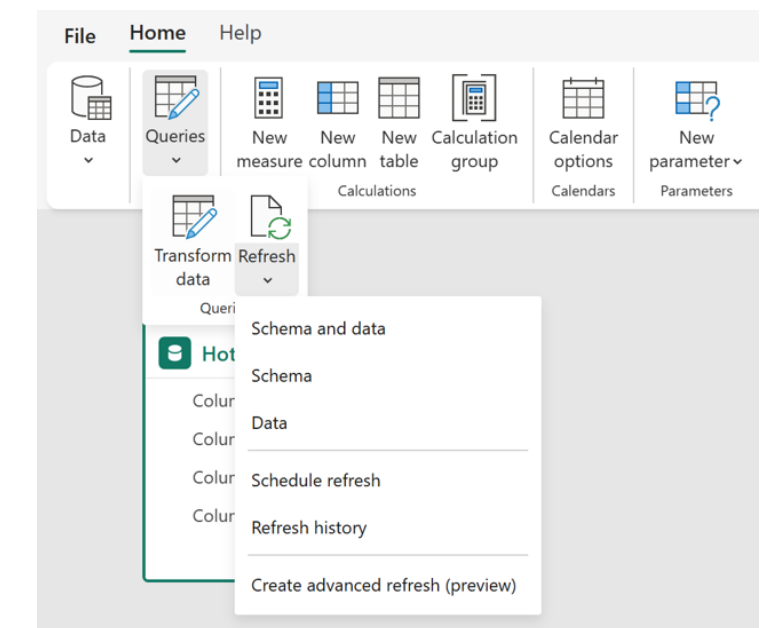
Generally Available (GA) – continued

- Azure map reference layer shape matching improvements
 - Now delivers improved performance
 - When matching your PowerBI data to shapes in a reference layer i.e.: joining sales data to a set of custom territories or regions in a GeoJSON file, reports will render faster
 - Interactions including: Filtering, Cross-highlighting and Zoom respond more smoothly
- Azure map loads filtered selection and autozoom
 - The Azure Map visual has a 30k data point rendering limit
 - **Previously** points beyond the 30k limit did not display:
 - even when you filtered the report to focus on a smaller area whose data did not load originally
 - **Now** when you filter to a smaller selection, the visual reloads to include the newly relevant data points that were not part of the initial 30k limit
 - The map will now show the complete picture of what you have filtered to, not just what fitted in the initial load

Announcements – Modelling

Increased control over the Semantic model refresh in PowerBI service

- Previously when you selected Refresh it always performed a schema sync followed by a data refresh
 - Depending on your requirements/ scenario this was not always the desired action
 - Like the experience in PowerBI Desktop you now have the following refresh options
 - Refresh schema and data
 - Sync schema only
 - Refresh data only
 - Additionally, refresh operations can be performed at Table Level
 - This allows you to refresh a specific table instead of the entire semantic model



Convert Direct Lake Tables to Import storage mode in Web modelling (Preview)

- Direct Lake on OneLake supports composite models by allowing for mixed Direct Lake tables with Import and DirectQuery tables.
 - You can now convert individual Direct Lake tables to Import storage mode directly in PowerBI web modelling

Announcements – Accessibility & Dark mode



Theming improvements for better accessibility

- Theming improvements that address colour contrast and readability across both the light and dark themes
 - Improved colour contrast across interface elements in both light and dark themes
 - More consistent theming that keeps controls, text and icons clearly distinguishable
 - Stronger foundation for accessibility that will benefit all users, regardless of their theme preference.

Better contrast for connector icons in Dark Mode

- Before: Icons with transparent backgrounds could blend into the surrounding UI and hard to identify
- After: When a connector has a transparent background it automatically receives a white background in Dark Mode

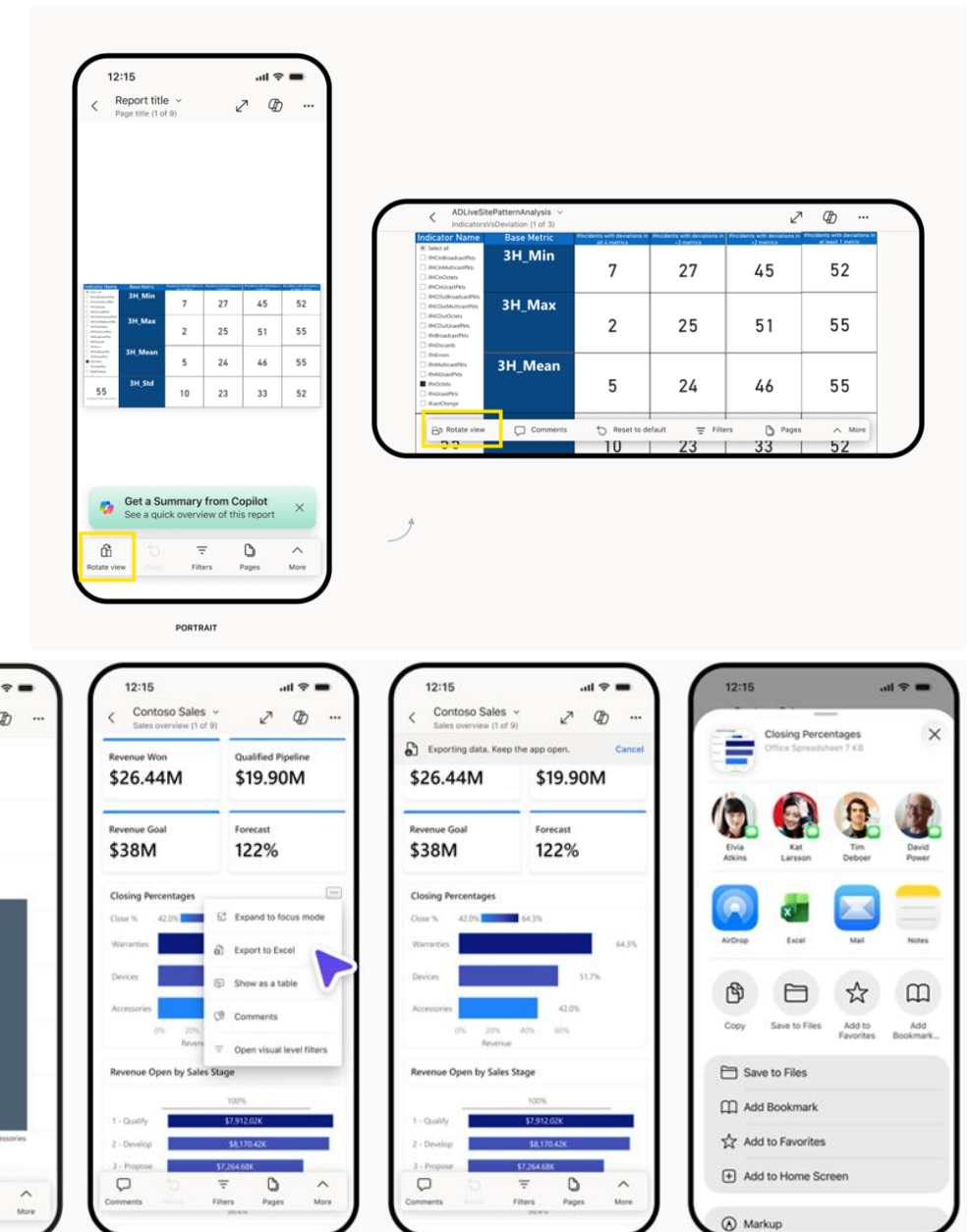
Announcements – Mobile

Rotate view in the mobile report footer

- Rotate view button is available in the PowerBI mobile report footer, which allows you to switch layouts even if phone is locked in portrait orientation
 - Ideal for reports that are not mobile optimized
 - Coming soon to PowerBI mobile for iOS and Android

Export data to Excel in the PowerBI mobile app

- As Analyst the question we receive the most is “Can we export to Excel?” – It is now possible
 - To export open a report visual in focus mode, or open the visual More Options (.... Menu)
 - Select Export Data
 - Export will start automatically using the supported Excel format for that visual
 - Exported data reflects current filters/ slicers, permissions, RLS etc
 - Once the file is ready, use the device’s sharing option to open, save or share

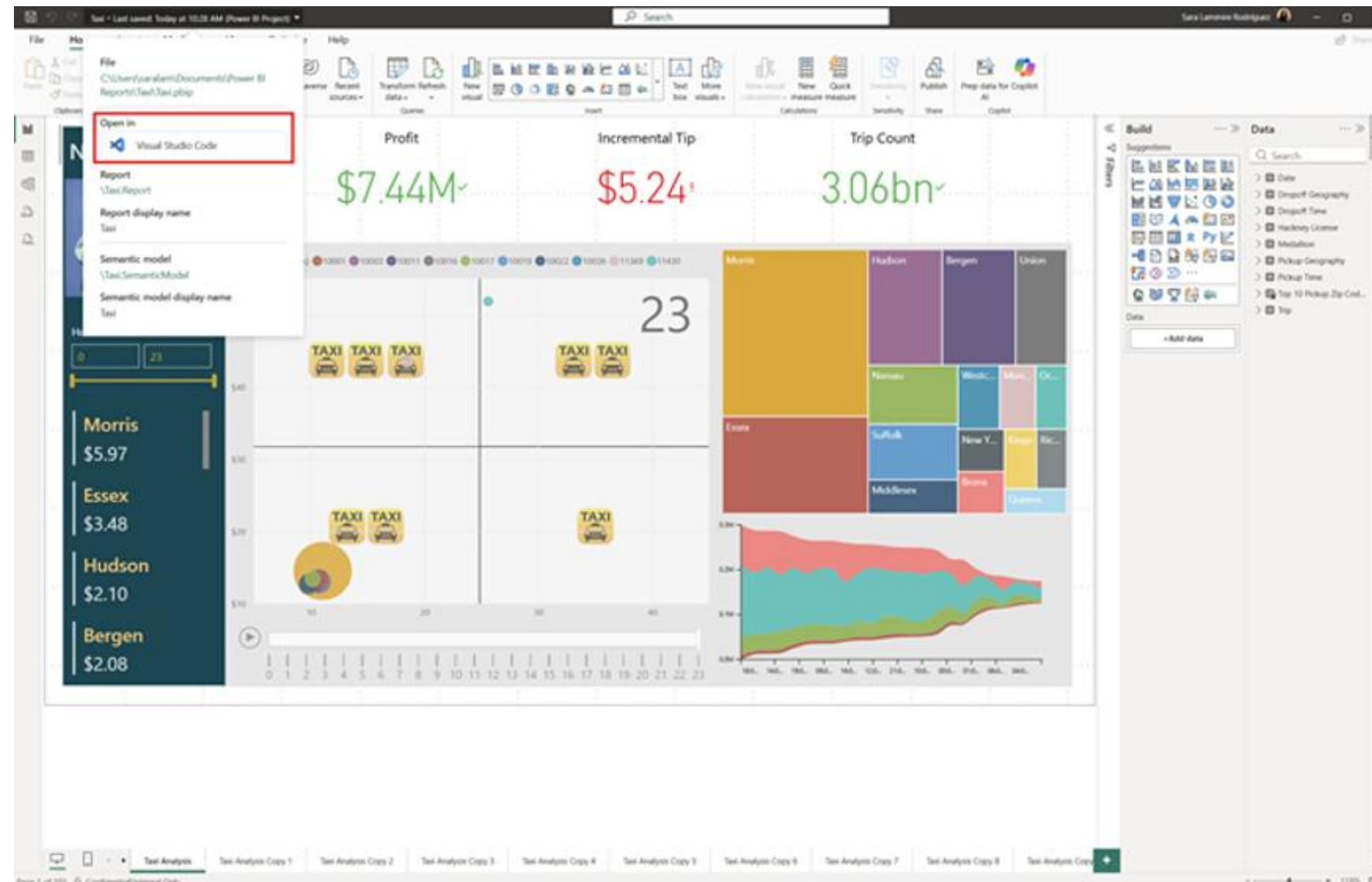


Announcements – Developers



Faster PBIP development with instant reloads and VS Code Integration

- If you are working with PowerBI Project files (PBIP) you can now edit project files outside PowerBI Desktop and reload changes instantly
 - *No more restarting the application* 🤖
 - *PowerBI automatically detects changes made to your files and prompts you to apply them with a single click*
- A built-in entry point that opens your project directly in VS Code is now added



Useful links

August 2026 Official link

<https://tinyurl.com/zapbiug-aug-2026>



BI User Group YouTube

<https://www.youtube.com/@biugsa>



Download PowerBI

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The End